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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Xi, Putin, Modi try to display unity

Differences remain, but warm greetings featured at summit

By David Pierson and Mujib Mashal
The New York Times

TIANJIN, China — It was a scene in eastern China almost certainly intended for an audience on the other side of the world:

The leaders of China, Russia and India, the three largest powers not aligned with the West, smiling and laughing like good friends as they greeted each other at a summit Monday.

It started with Prime Minister Narendra Modi of India and President Vladimir Putin of Russia holding hands and walking into a meeting hall filled with other world leaders. They headed straight for President Xi Jinping

of China, shook hands and formed a close circle. A few words were exchanged before translators joined the huddle. Putin cracked a broad smile, and Modi let out a big laugh. At one point, Modi joined hands with the two leaders.

The tableau carried multiple messages, analysts said. The bonhomie between Xi and Putin was meant to convey a close bond between them as leaders of an alternative world order chal-

lenging the United States. Modi sought to show that India has other important friends — including China, regardless of an unresolved border dispute — if the Trump administration chooses to continue alienating New Delhi with tariffs.

“Optics is a key part of this summit, and the White House should grasp that its policies will result in other countries looking for alternatives to meet their inter-

ests,” said Manoj Kewalramani, head of Indo-Pacific studies at the Takshashila Institution in Bangalore, India.

That imagery in the city of Tianjin, where more than 20 leaders from mostly Central Asia and South Asia gathered, showed how the geopolitical disruption caused by President Donald Trump has given China and Russia a platform

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Charged in 1998, Urbina awaits trial

Judge sets date to hear assault, murder case in Back of Yards

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

For more than 17 years, one of the FBI’s “Most Wanted” fugitives was hiding out in Mexico.

Charged in 1998 with the rape and murder of a 22-year-old woman in Back of the Yards, Fidel Urbina evaded capture until 2016, when he was arrested by Mexican federal authorities on a U.S. extradition warrant.

He has remained in Cook County Jail ever since, awaiting trial in the alleged murder of Gabriella Torres — a case that originated during the Clinton administration.

There could be an end to the saga within sight. In recent weeks, a Cook County judge finally set aside time in November to hear Urbina’s jury trial, while a motion to suppress evidence gathered at the crime scene was also denied.

But another crucial pretrial ruling is still to come — stemming from a 53-year-old Chicago police misconduct investigation into the lead detective in the murder case — leaving the door open to more potential delays.

Earlier this year, prosecutors made a disclosure to the court and Urbina’s attorneys. A key witness, the since-retired Chicago Police Department detective who investigated Torres’ killing, informed the state’s attorney’s office that he was suspended for a month without pay in 1972 after he was accused of stealing cash from a civilian’s wallet.

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Another hidden cost to EVs

The insurance premiums on electric vehicles are, on average, a whopping 49% higher than those for gas-powered cars, according to new data from the digital insurance platform Insurify. **Business**

Established beacons and rising stars

Labor Day weekend visitors to the Pritzker Pavilion in Chicago got a primer in jazz and its many strains. Hannah Edgar reviews the Chicago Jazz Festival. **Arts & Living**

US government shutdown looming

When Congress returns from its August recess, the most urgent task will be to avoid a shutdown on Sept. 30, when federal funding runs out. **Nation & World**



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Labor Day rally targets billionaires

Protesters participate in a chant as they walk through Fulton Market during the Workers Over Billionaires march in the West Loop in Chicago on Monday. Speakers included Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson and Chicago Federation of Labor President Bob Reiter. **Story, Page 2**



A worker defoliates cannabis plants in a greenhouse and flowering room at the Curaleaf cannabis growing facility in Litchfield, Ill., on Aug. 15. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

A GROWING DEBATE

Cannabis firms want the option of cultivating outside, but state regulators keep trying to regulate how the plant is produced

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

Most legal cannabis in Illinois is grown without the sun, wind, rain, or even, in some cases, soil.

But opportunities to grow cannabis outdoors in Illinois have been limited. State law, which requires that cannabis be grown in an “enclosed, locked facility,” allows greenhouses. But the law doesn’t address similar facilities like screen houses and hoop houses, which feature a

metal frame with plastic sheets. The lack of clarity over the legality of such facilities has led to a tug-of-war between the cannabis industry and state regulators.

Two companies won state permission to grow cannabis in screened houses, but regulators later tried to revoke that permission. The companies went to court and won rulings that allowed them to keep growing outdoors.

A third company that is also one of the largest — Curaleaf

— has filed a lawsuit seeking permission from the state to grow outdoors. Curaleaf, which already operates a greenhouse, wants to build a hoop house with 42,900 square feet of plant canopy space, an irrigation system and storage space. It also wants to build two additional hoop houses in the future.

Curaleaf Chairman and CEO Boris Jordan said in a statement that his company’s proposal

Turn to Cannabis, Page 4

NU professor doesn’t regret decision to leave US

Trump policies toward academia unsettle higher ed.

By Kate Armanini
Chicago Tribune

Economist Matthias Doepke once believed the U.S. was the pinnacle of academia: open, diverse, global. He immigrated to Chicago from Germany to pursue his doctorate, and most of his classmates were international students.

“That’s an exciting thing, to bring talent together from everywhere,” said Doepke, now 54. “That’s how science is supposed to work.”



It was an American Dream. He joined the Northwestern University faculty in 2008, with reams of research to his name. He married an American, became a U.S. citizen and raised three sons in Evanston with his wife.

But their shiny life buckled when President Donald Trump took office in 2016. Threats to academic freedom and hostility towards immigrants seemed eerily reminiscent of past authoritarian regimes. To Doepke, it felt profoundly

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